FRANMARINE UNDERWATER SERVICES PTY LTD

BOW RAMP OPERATIONS

Procedure

MV SEAGULL | UVI: 425689 | Class 2D, 2E

Marine Order 504 (2024) — Schedule 1 Compliance

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Revision History

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Approval

Role	Name	Date
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Review Frequency

This document shall be reviewed at least every 12 months, or sooner following a significant incident, change of operations, vessel modification, or change in applicable legislation.

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1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This procedure establishes the safe operating procedure for the drop-down bow ramp fitted to MV Seagull. The bow ramp is a key feature of this landing barge and is used for loading and unloading equipment, materials, and personnel at beach landings, boat ramps, and alongside structures.

1.1 Regulatory Reference

Marine Order 504 (2024), Schedule 1, Clause 11(5). WHS Regulation 2017 (NSW).

2. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

- Only trained and competent personnel shall operate the bow ramp.
- The deck load shall not exceed 1.2 tonnes.
- All personnel on deck during bow ramp operations shall wear PFDs.
- The vessel must be stable and securely beached or moored before the ramp is lowered.
- No person shall stand in the path of the ramp while it is being lowered or raised.

3. PRE-OPERATION CHECKS

- Visually inspect the bow ramp mechanism, hinges, and locking pins for damage or corrosion.
- Check the ramp cables or hydraulic lines (if fitted) for wear or damage.
- Confirm the ramp deck surface has adequate grip (non-slip tread or grip tape).
- Verify the load to be carried does not exceed the 1.2 t deck load capacity.

4. BOW RAMP LANDING

4.1 Approach

- Approach the landing site at slow speed, bow-on.
- Assess the landing surface for debris, gradient, and stability.
- When bow touches, trim the outboard up to protect the propeller and lower unit.

4.2 Lowering the Ramp

- Ensure the vessel is firmly grounded or secured against the landing surface.
- Clear all personnel from the ramp drop zone.
- Release the ramp locking pins or mechanism.
- Lower the ramp in a controlled manner.

- Confirm the ramp is fully lowered and resting securely on the landing surface before use.

5. LOADING AND UNLOADING

- Load and unload equipment methodically. Distribute weight evenly across the deck.
- Do not exceed 1.2 t total deck load at any time.
- Secure all cargo on deck before transit.
- Personnel should not walk on the ramp at the same time as equipment is being moved.

6. RAISING THE BOW RAMP AND DEPARTURE

- Confirm all personnel and equipment are clear of the ramp.
- Raise the ramp in a controlled manner.
- Engage the ramp locking pins or mechanism. Confirm the ramp is fully secured.
- Trim the outboard down before departing.
- Reverse off the landing at slow speed.

7. REFERENCES

- FUS-SMS-SGL-05C Mooring and Berthing
- FUS-SMS-SGL-05D Means of Access